

August 2026

Dear Sandra,

I've worked in Lafayette long enough to know when a home on Hidden Oaks Drive is worth paying attention to, and 53 Hidden Oaks is exactly that kind of property. The combination of a 39,000-square-foot lot, a wine cellar capable of housing over 2,000 bottles, and Venetian plaster walls throughout is genuinely rare at any price point in Lamorinda. When I saw the listing come off the market after 98 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out personally.

A home with these credentials shouldn't sit for three months. The estate has every element that motivates a serious Lafayette buyer - resort-style grounds, a chef's kitchen, a primary suite with a private balcony, and outdoor entertaining infrastructure that most buyers have to imagine. What the listing history suggests is that the marketing never built a complete picture of what this property actually is. At \$810 per square foot, a buyer needed a compelling case for why this home commands that number. That case wasn't made clearly enough, and I think that gap is what kept qualified buyers from moving forward.

I've put together a short analysis of what I believe created friction during the listing period, along with a framework for how a relaunch could be structured differently. The packet walks through the three specific areas where the strategy fell short and what a targeted approach would look like for a home at this level.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation at whatever pace feels right for you.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Lafayette, CA 94549

4.0 Beds · 5 Baths · 5,300 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Resort-Scale Lafayette Estate - and a Listing That Never Showed It Off

53 Hidden Oaks Drive is a 5,300-square-foot custom estate built in 2006, sitting on nearly nine-tenths of an acre in one of Lafayette's most desirable corridors. The home offers the kind of depth that serious buyers at this price point are actively looking for: Venetian plaster walls and hand-scraped hardwood floors throughout, a wine cellar and tasting room with capacity for over 2,000 bottles, a fully equipped outdoor kitchen with a Lynx pizza oven and DCS rotisserie, a bocce court, pool and spa, and a primary suite with a private balcony and spa-inspired bath. Owned solar and dual generators add a practical layer that resonates with buyers thinking long-term. This is a property with a story.

A 98-day run without a sale doesn't reflect the quality of the home. It reflects a strategy that didn't translate what makes this property exceptional into something buyers could feel before they ever walked through the door. At \$4,295,000 and \$810 per square foot, this listing needed to actively find and persuade a specific buyer who would recognize the value. Instead, it relied on standard distribution and waited. The buyers who would have paid full price likely never saw the home in a way that moved them to act.

\$4,295,000

List Price

\$810/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above all else: give the right buyer a complete, immersive experience of this property before they ever schedule a showing. The wine cellar, the outdoor kitchen, the scale of the grounds, the craftsmanship details - these are the reasons someone pays \$4.3 million in Lafayette, and they need to be front and center from the first moment a buyer encounters this home online.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 98 Days Without a Pivot

After 98 days on the market, buyer psychology had long since shifted from curiosity to suspicion. Past the 45-day mark, the typical buyer stops asking what makes a home great and starts asking what everyone else saw that they missed. For a \$4.295 million estate with no HOA and a genuinely rare feature set, that stigma is entirely unearned - but it accumulates quickly without an active change in strategy. The listing didn't run out of time. It ran out of ideas. A home at this level needs a buyer who has been found, not a buyer who happened to scroll past.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses geo-targeted digital campaigns to reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda before they've identified a specific property - putting this home in front of decision-makers rather than waiting for them to find it.

Friction #2: The Visual Story Was Never Told

A temperature-controlled wine cellar with 2,000-bottle capacity, a bocce court lit by string lights, a Lynx pizza oven in an outdoor kitchen, Venetian plaster ceilings - these are features that command a premium because buyers can feel them. But standard MLS photography flattens all of that. Front elevation, wide-angle rooms, flat lighting - none of it conveys the scale of a 39,248-square-foot lot or the texture of a hand-scraped hardwood floor. At \$810 per square foot, buyers comparing this home against alternatives need to experience what they're getting before they drive out for a showing. Without the right visual depth, this home's most compelling features registered as footnotes in the description rather than reasons to act.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through every room - including the wine cellar and tasting room - from anywhere, any time, and is especially critical for the out-of-area and busy professional buyers most likely to be shopping at this price point.

Friction #3: A Premium Price That Was Never Defended

At \$810 per square foot, 53 Hidden Oaks sits at the lower end of the premium tier for Lafayette - which means the value case was actually very strong and very makeable. But that case has to be made explicitly. When a listing at this price point doesn't show buyers - in clear, concrete terms - what they're getting that they can't find in a \$720-per-square-foot alternative, price-conscious buyers move on before they ever book a showing. The owned solar, the copper gutters, the custom walnut built-ins, the dual generators, the resort grounds - these are not cosmetic details. They're thousands of dollars of value that the listing treated as supporting copy rather than the headline.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement gives this listing a structured, narrative-forward presence on the platform where most buyers start their search - routing all inquiries directly back to the listing team rather than to third-party agents who don't know the home.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	53 Hidden Oaks Dr	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$810/sqft	Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft Updated: \$780–\$840/sqft
Lot / Setting	39,248 sq ft, resort grounds, pool and spa, bocce court, fire pit	Typical Lafayette lot: 7,500–15,000 sq ft
Architectural Character	Custom 2006 estate, Venetian plaster walls and ceilings, hand-scraped hardwood throughout	Standard updated finishes, builder-grade millwork
Premium Features	2,000-bottle wine cellar, outdoor kitchen with pizza oven, owned solar, dual generators, copper gutters	Standard floor plan, single system, no specialty rooms
HOA	None	Varies - \$0 to \$300+/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$810/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$810 per square foot, 53 Hidden Oaks is priced in the lower range of the updated tier and just below the entry point of the formal premium tier - a position that is entirely justified by the lot size, custom construction quality, and specialty features, but one that requires a deliberate marketing strategy to defend. The data supports the number. The prior listing didn't tell buyers why.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Case from the Ground Up

The single most important thing a relaunch can do for this home is give buyers a complete, immersive visual experience before they ever set foot inside. Cinematic photography, a Sky Tour to convey the scale and setting of the nearly one-acre lot, and a full 3D Matterport walkthrough - including the wine cellar and outdoor entertaining spaces - transform casual online browsers into motivated showing requests. Buyers at \$4.3 million are comparing carefully and shopping hard online first. The home that shows the best digitally gets the showing.

Pillar II - Take the Home to the Right Buyers, Not Just the MLS

The buyer for 53 Hidden Oaks is likely a high-earning professional from San Francisco or the inner East Bay who is researching Lamorinda before they know exactly what they want. They are not waiting on Zillow - they need to be found where they are already spending time. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach this audience specifically, putting the home in front of decision-makers who are actively in-market but haven't yet locked onto a property. That proactive distribution is what a passive MLS strategy skips.

Pillar III - Tell the Story That Justifies the Number

Owned solar, copper gutters, dual generators, a 2,000-bottle wine cellar, custom walnut closet built-ins, a Lynx outdoor kitchen - this home has thousands of dollars in infrastructure that the prior listing buried in the remarks. A relaunch needs to lead with these details, frame them as computable value, and give buyers the rationale to feel confident at \$4.295 million before the first offer is written. The price is fair. The marketing just never made the case for it.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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